From Spreadsheets to a Working ERP

How a distribution business is replacing seven Excel workbooks with a single system — built in six weeks by its owner

Case study — medical consumables & pharmaceutical distribution

The Owner Had Become the Bottleneck in His Own Business



Every customer question — an account balance, a statement, a previous price — routed through one person. Seven separate Excel workbooks held customers, suppliers, purchasing, expenses, capital and pricing. None of them talked to each other, and only the owner could reconcile them.

The constraint was not the data. It was that one person had to be available for anyone else to do their job.

Analysis First, Then the System

The build did not start with software. It started with three analytical models, each answering a question the business could not otherwise answer:

1. **A pricing model —** six years of transactions across every customer-product pair, reduced to three numbers: the floor that customer has accepted, the recommended price, and the ceiling that has been charged and accepted.

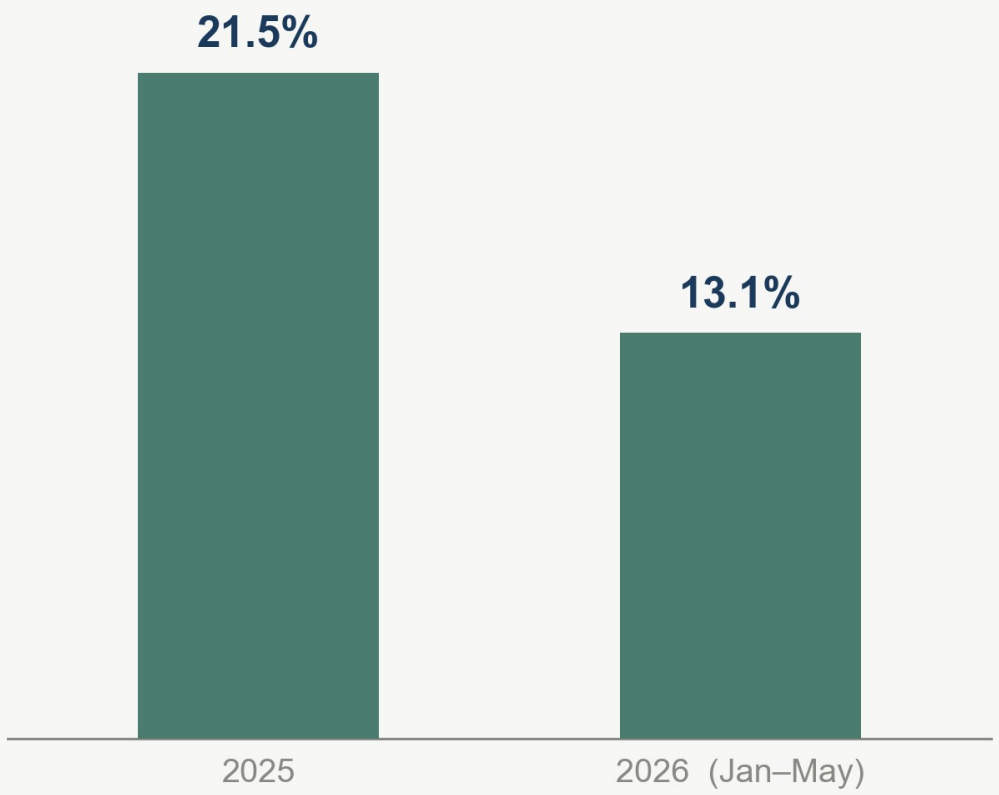
2. **A financial model —** every invoice, payment, expense and capital movement pulled into one workbook, so profit, receivables and return on working capital could be seen for the first time.

3. **A dashboard —** the operating metrics, tracked continuously rather than assembled at year end.

Only then was it clear what the system needed to do. The ERP was not the starting point — it was where the three models were consolidated so the whole team could use them, not just the owner.

The Pricing Model Was Backtested Against Two Years of Real Transactions

Average uplift vs prices actually charged



Method — For each customer-product pair, the floor is the minimum sell/buy ratio that relationship has ever accepted. The recommendation adds the median observed gap above that floor; the ceiling adds the 90th percentile.

The rule that matters — The recommendation never undercuts the last price actually charged. In a relationship-driven market, dropping a price implies the earlier one was unfair and trains customers to wait for discounts.

Fallback — Where a customer has no history for a product, the model falls back to the cross-customer rate for that product, then to a tier default. Every price carries a confidence level.

Estimated annual cost of pricing from memory, before the model: a mid-six-figure sum in local currency.

90% of the Owner's Time on Routine Queries, Designed Out

90%

Before

Account balances, statements and price history were only obtainable by asking the owner, who updated the spreadsheets when free. Each question was a round trip of hours or days.

By design

Each role gets direct access to the data its job requires — balances, statements, price history, supplier comparisons — on demand, without routing through the owner.

What it changes

Not just time. It removes the owner as the dependency for other people's work — the constraint that actually caps a small business.

Estimated from current query volumes; the system enters production this month.

The Approach

I analyse operations data to find where money and time are leaking — then build the systems that close the gap.

What that looks like: a diagnostic on your existing data, a written analysis and executive presentation, and where it makes sense, a working tool rather than a report.

Built by an operator, not a consultant.

Pharmacist by training, MBA. I have owned and run a medical consumables and pharmaceutical distribution business since 2018. I built this system to run it, and it goes live this month.

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